

D377

Digital Marketing Foundations

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A plumbing company, family-owned since 1985, wants to show up in Google's unpaid results for "emergency plumber near me." The owner just bought three new service vans. Which action directly supports that goal?

- A. Buy a pay-per-click ad for the phrase.
- B. Raise its Google Ads bids so its organic ranking climbs.
- C. Put photos of the new vans on the homepage.
- D. Optimize its Google Business Profile and service pages for local emergency-plumbing terms and earn local reviews.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A startup has budget but a brand-new website with no backlinks, and it needs visitors for a two-week launch that starts tomorrow. Which channel delivers traffic fastest?

- A. Paid search (PPC) ads
- B. SEO, because organic traffic is always cheaper and faster
- C. A new SEO blog-post series
- D. Wait for Google to rank the site first, since ads require organic rank

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A display ad for a yoga studio, featuring its award-winning lead instructor, served 50,000 impressions and got 400 clicks. Twenty people bought a class pack. What is the click-through rate?

- A. 0.04%
- B. 125
- C. 5%
- D. 0.8%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A landing page for a free webinar got 2,500 visitors from a partner's newsletter, and 175 of them registered. The page loads in 1.8 seconds. What is the conversion rate?

- A. 14.3%
- B. 93%
- C. 1.8%
- D. 7%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A sign-up page converts at 4%. The team needs 300 sign-ups this month. How many visitors does the page need?

- A. 12
- B. 300
- C. 7,500
- D. 75

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A paid search campaign spent \$3,000, earned 1,500 clicks, and produced 60 purchases averaging \$90 each. The agency also charged a one-time \$500 setup fee last quarter. What was the cost per acquisition for this campaign?

- A. \$50
- B. \$2
- C. \$58.33
- D. 1.8

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A campaign's target cost per acquisition is \$40, and the plan calls for 75 conversions. What is the maximum budget?

- A. \$1.88
- B. \$3,000
- C. \$115
- D. \$40

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

An online bookstore with a warehouse in Ohio wants to know whether a green “Buy now” button beats its current blue one. Which test design isolates the effect of the button color?

- A. Randomly split visitors between two pages identical except for button color, and run until the result is reliable.
- B. Change the button color and the headline together on version B.
- C. Stop after one day, since the leading version always wins.
- D. Show green in March and blue in April, then compare sales.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9.

A retailer shares the same spring-sale link in an email, a Facebook post, and a podcast ad read. Its analytics show one big spike labeled direct traffic. The email went to 30,000 subscribers. What would have let the team see which channel drove the visits?

- A. Just count total visits, since the channel does not matter if sales rose.
- B. A separate link for each channel with its own UTM source, medium, and campaign tags.
- C. Nothing; analytics always detects podcast and email visitors on its own.
- D. Sending the email to more subscribers.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10.

A payroll software company learns that small-business owners first search phrases like “how to pay my first employee.” The company won a design award last year. Which content fits this awareness stage?

- A. A pricing page comparing the company’s plans.
- B. A free how-to guide and checklist for paying a first employee, without a hard sell.
- C. A demo-request form.
- D. A press release about the design award.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A prospect has compared three vendors and now asks for proof that your product works for companies like theirs. Which content fits this stage?

- A.** An introductory blog post defining the problem.
- B.** An infographic on general industry trends.
- C.** A case study from a similar customer, plus a free trial.
- D.** No content; at this stage only a salesperson matters.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A marketer wants everyone who downloads an ebook to get a series of follow-up emails over two weeks, and anyone who then views the pricing page to be flagged for sales. The company uses a popular CRM. Which setup does this?

- A.** Add downloaders to the monthly newsletter sent to all contacts.
- B.** Have a coordinator email each downloader by hand.
- C.** A behavior-triggered workflow with lead scoring that routes high-scoring contacts to sales.
- D.** Upgrade to a larger CRM plan.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A plumbing company, ~~family owned since 1985,~~ wants to show up in Google's unpaid results for "emergency plumber near me." ~~The owner just bought three new service vans.~~ Which action directly supports that goal?

Target word: action that improves organic ranking **Decides:** "Unpaid results" means SEO.

A	Confusion set	That is a paid placement, not an unpaid result.
B	Adjacent category	Ad spend does not affect organic ranking.
C	Camouflage	Answers the van detail; it does nothing for the target keyword.
D	Correct	Local SEO work is what moves unpaid rankings.

2. Answer A Concept 1 • transfer

A startup has budget but a brand-new website with no backlinks, and it needs visitors for a two-week launch that starts tomorrow. Which channel delivers traffic fastest?

Target word: reverse: from urgency to channel **Decides:** Only paid placement is available immediately.

A	Correct	Ads can run as soon as the campaign is approved; organic rank takes months.
B	Absolute language	Organic can be cheaper over time but is not fast for a new site.
C	Confusion set	Organic content needs time to be indexed and earn rank.
D	Inverted operation	Paid placement does not depend on organic rank.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A display ad for a yoga studio, ~~featuring its award-winning lead instructor,~~ served 50,000 impressions and got 400 clicks. Twenty people bought a class pack. What is the click-through rate?

Target word: CTR **Decides:** Clicks / impressions = 400 / 50,000.

A	Adjacent category	20 / 50,000 is purchases per impression.
B	Inverted operation	50,000 / 400 divides the wrong way.
C	Confusion set	20 / 400 is the conversion rate of clicks, not CTR.
D	Correct	$400 / 50,000 = 0.008 = 0.8\%$.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A landing page for a free webinar got 2,500 visitors from a partner's newsletter, and 175 of them registered. ~~The page loads in 1.8 seconds.~~ What is the conversion rate?

Target word: conversion rate **Decides:** Registrations / visitors = 175 / 2,500.

A	Inverted operation	$2,500 / 175 = 14.3$, divided the wrong way and mislabeled as a percent.
B	Adjacent category	The share who did not register.
C	Wrong stem number	The load time, not a conversion figure.
D	Correct	$175 / 2,500 = 0.07 = 7\%$.

5. Answer C Concept 3 • transfer

A sign-up page converts at 4%. The team needs 300 sign-ups this month. How many visitors does the page need?

Target word: solve for visitors **Decides:** Visitors = conversions / rate = 300 / 0.04.

A	Inverted operation	300×0.04 multiplies instead of dividing.
B	Wrong stem number	The sign-up goal, not the visitors needed.
C	Correct	$300 / 0.04 = 7,500$; check: $7,500 \times 4\% = 300$.
D	Dropped element	$300 / 4$ drops the percent conversion.

6. Answer A Concept 4

A paid search campaign spent \$3,000, earned 1,500 clicks, and produced 60 purchases averaging \$90 each. ~~The agency also charged a one-time \$500 setup fee last quarter.~~ What was the cost per acquisition for this campaign?

Target word: CPA **Decides:** Campaign spend / purchases = $\$3,000 / 60$.

A	Correct	$\$3,000 / 60 = \50 per purchase.
B	Confusion set	$\$3,000 / 1,500$ is cost per click.
C	Camouflage	Adds last quarter's setup fee, which is not this campaign's spend.
D	Adjacent category	$\$5,400$ revenue / $\$3,000$ is ROAS, not CPA.

7. Answer B Concept 4 • transfer

A campaign's target cost per acquisition is \$40, and the plan calls for 75 conversions. What is the maximum budget?

Target word: solve for spend **Decides:** Spend = CPA $\times$ conversions.

A	Inverted operation	Divides 75 by 40 instead of multiplying.
B	Correct	$\$40 \times 75 = \$3,000$.
C	Inverted operation	Adds the two numbers instead of multiplying.
D	Wrong stem number	The per-conversion target, not the total budget.

8. Answer A Concept 5

An online bookstore ~~with a warehouse in Ohio~~ wants to know whether a green "Buy now" button beats its current blue one. Which test design isolates the effect of the button color?

Target word: valid test design **Decides:** Random split, one variable changed.

A	Correct	One variable, random assignment, enough data.
B	Dropped element	Drops control of the second variable, so the cause is unclear.
C	Absolute language	Early leads often reverse; small samples are unreliable.
D	Adjacent category	A before-and-after comparison mixes in seasonal and traffic changes.

9. Answer B Concept 6

A retailer shares the same spring-sale link in an email, a Facebook post, and a podcast ad read. Its analytics show one big spike labeled direct traffic. ~~The email went to 30,000 subscribers.~~ What would have let the team see which channel drove the visits?

Target word: how to attribute traffic by channel **Decides:** Identical links cannot be told apart.

A	Dropped element	Drops the channel question the team is asking.
B	Correct	Unique UTM tags let analytics credit each channel.
C	Absolute language	Untagged email and audio visits often show up as direct.
D	Camouflage	List size does not identify the traffic source.

10. Answer B Concept 7

A payroll software company learns that small-business owners first search phrases like “how to pay my first employee.” ~~The company won a design award last year.~~ Which content fits this awareness stage?

Target word: awareness-stage content **Decides:** The buyer is learning about a problem, not comparing vendors.

A	Adjacent category	Pricing fits the decision stage.
B	Correct	Educational content answers the awareness-stage question.
C	Confusion set	A decision-stage conversion point, too early here.
D	Camouflage	Answers the award detail; it does not answer the searcher’s question.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A prospect has compared three vendors and now asks for proof that your product works for companies like theirs. Which content fits this stage?

Target word: reverse: decision-stage content **Decides:** The buyer is choosing among vendors.

A	Inverted operation	Awareness content for a buyer who is past that stage.
B	Confusion set	Top-of-funnel content that does not prove fit.
C	Correct	Decision-stage content proves fit for this buyer.
D	Absolute language	Proof content is exactly what decision-stage buyers use.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A marketer wants everyone who downloads an ebook to get a series of follow-up emails over two weeks, and anyone who then views the pricing page to be flagged for sales. ~~The company uses a popular CRM.~~ Which setup does this?

Target word: automation setup **Decides:** Behavior triggers messages and a sales hand-off.

A	Adjacent category	A batch send is not triggered by behavior.
B	Dropped element	Drops the automation and the pricing-page trigger.
C	Correct	Triggers and scoring automate both steps.
D	Camouflage	Answers the CRM detail; a plan tier is not a workflow.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	SEO vs. paid search	SEO earns unpaid rankings over time; paid search (PPC) buys immediate ad placement; paying for ads does not raise organic rank.	Believing a bigger ad budget lifts organic ranking.	“Unpaid” or “organic” results vs. “right away.”
2	Click-through rate	CTR = clicks / impressions.	Dividing conversions by clicks and calling it CTR.	Impressions and clicks in the same stem.
3	Conversion rate and CRO	Conversion rate = conversions / visitors (or sessions); CRO raises that share, not the traffic.	Dividing visitors by conversions, or using a non-rate number.	Visitors and completed actions on one page.
4	Cost per acquisition	CPA = ad spend / conversions; CPC = spend / clicks.	Confusing CPA with CPC or ROAS, or adding unrelated costs.	Spend, clicks, and purchases all given.
5	A/B testing	Randomly split traffic between versions that differ in one element, and run until results are reliable.	Changing several things at once or comparing different time periods.	“Which change caused the result?”
6	Campaign tracking with UTM tags	Unique UTM parameters (source, medium, campaign) on each link let analytics credit visits to the right channel.	Assuming analytics will automatically know which offline or email source drove a visit.	Same link used in several channels; traffic lumped as direct.
7	Content by buyer’s-journey stage	Awareness content educates; consideration content compares approaches; decision content proves your fit (case studies, demos, trials).	Putting a sales pitch in awareness content, or a basic explainer at the decision stage.	What the buyer is searching for or asking at that moment.
8	Marketing automation	Automation sends the right message when a contact’s behavior triggers it, and uses lead scoring to hand ready leads to sales.	Treating a monthly batch blast or manual follow-up as automation.	“Every time a contact does X, then Y happens.”

Course scope (public description): Digital Marketing Foundations provides learners with knowledge in the dynamic and evolving field of marketing that uses the internet and digital technologies to reach customers. This course provides foundational knowledge in digital marketing disciplines, including social media marketing, content marketing, marketing automation, search engine optimization (SEO), paid search (PPC), conversion rate optimization (CRO), mobile marketing, and web analytics. Learners explore how a digital marketing strategy is developed and executed, along with how digital marketing is integrated within an organization's overall strategy. This course provides learners with the opportunity to complete the HubSpot Marketing Software certification to learn marketing automation software that is used in industry to assist marketers in their digital marketing execution. Emphasis throughout the course is placed on industry best practices, and the course content aligns with the Online Marketing Certified Associate (OMCA) certification to prepare students for this third-party certification.